

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 29

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

Oh, blessed moment! We can now embrace KF Confession 7:

We commit now to live in reality, choosing to believe rather than judge.

Last week we looked again at the letter from James. We learned that the wisdom, or cleverness, of cheap, habitual shortcuts will inevitably result in misoriented outcomes. Our inner conflicts and compelling needs make us a target for demonic infiltration. In order to create outcomes of orientation, we must regularly think and act in ways that will promote calm and peace in our lives. Through prayer and meditation, mindfulness, circulation, and the use of our KF tools, we are sowing seeds of oriented choices, which over time will produce a harvest of oriented outcomes. We will then have more and more access to the wisdom from above. The effort we make to plant these seeds is the cause that produces the glorious effect of a peaceful and fulfilled life—a life that flows out of a mature and fully equipped True Self.

We really do need to respect the reality of cause and effect. Whatever we do, whether oriented or misoriented, we plant seeds. Seeds determine the harvest, and a quality harvest begins with quality seed. The Bible tells us how to plant quality seed—seeds of orientation, which will produce the abundant harvest of an ever-developing life.

Perhaps the most famous passage about cause and effect is found in chapter 6 of Paul's letter to the Galatians. This is Nancy's paraphrase of **Galatians 6:7–10**:

⁷Do not be influenced to wander and misorient. God is not to be outwitted or sneered at. This is how it works: whatever a person sows, that will they also reap. ⁸For the one who sows into the flesh (or the Idol Self), out of the Idol Self will reap deterioration and ruin; but the one who sows into the spirit (or the True Self), out of the True Self will reap an ever-developing life. ⁹Since this is so, do not be negligent in doing what is virtuous and beautiful. If we do not relax our effort, we will reap at the proper time and in due season.

¹⁰Therefore, when any opportunity presents itself to you, perform what is of benefit to all, but especially to the trustworthy community.

Take a deep breath.

In this passage from Galatians we can see that God supports the cause and effect process, but in our misorientation we don't want to believe that. We prefer to put energy and resources into our cravings, judgments, and pride—and yet we continue to hope for satisfying outcomes. Self-hate uses up so much precious energy. We waste energy making judgments that generate self-hate, and then we expend more energy chasing perfection in a frantic attempt to maintain our pride and protect ourselves from a further onslaught of self-hate. We can choose to sow either judgment or love, and the reality is that we will reap whatever we sow, whether in our work, our relationships, own health and development, or in our play. In KF, we train to sow our energy and resources into the ways of eternity, and, as a result, our True Self is reaping eternal life from the Spirit of God. Eternal life constitutes all of the glorious qualities of growth and orientation that we can experience in this life and beyond. We are learning to choose this life, even when we don't feel like it. This real life is a life of courageously doing productive, orienting things—a life of growing into our potential as spiritual creatures living in this material world.

Now, let's turn to our beloved letter from James. This is Nancy's translation of **James 5:7–9**:

⁷Therefore, be long-tempered my siblings, until the Lord presents Himself. Consider this: the farmer waits for the valuable and prized fruit of the earth, being long-tempered about it, until he receives the early and afternoon showers. ⁸You also, be long-tempered. Resolve to turn your hearts around because the presence of the Lord approaches. ⁹Siblings, do not groan in judgment against others or you may be judged. Look! The real Judge is standing at the door!

Take a deep breath.

You might think of it this way: *My life is what it is because . . . Be your own cause. (Repeat)* You are a powerful creature. You are the cause that generated the outcomes you have. Your power to generate outcomes can be redirected to generate other outcomes. Outcomes are not created by magic or luck; you create them by your choices. Begin to create new outcomes by becoming the cause of your own orientation and see what happens. Take care of your business. Your business is to sow good seed, do good work, speak good thoughts, give good gifts, and wait. Allow others time to take care of their business; and, especially, with humility allow God time to take care of His.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Great Sower of the logos, show me where to sow good seeds that will reap an abundant harvest. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for this time to heal and train together. Remind us that we are the cause of our own lives. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to become more effective and to flourish in our connection with our True Self and design, with our community and the rest of Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.